HOLY ANGEL UNIVERSITY | INSTITUTE FOR CHRISTIAN FORMATION AND SOCIAL INTEGRATION

CHARACTER EDUCATION PARTNERSHIP DESK

ANGELITE BIBLE SHARING (ABS)

TEMPLATE FOR GROUP REFLECTION
ON A 1 SHORT BOND PAPER

Date: 07 / 09 / 2023
Group Name: ABS 1
Scriptural Passage: Matthew 16: 21 - 17
Theme: Jesus Predicts His Death

Group Members (Alphabetical arrangement)	Tasking	Bible		Chosen Phrase from the Scriptural Reading
		Printed/ hard copy	e-bible	
Madlambayan, Kris Dane	Facilitator/sharer		✓	24" Whoever wants to be my disciple must deny themselves and take up their cross and follow me."
Mallari, Kenneth Nash	Opening prayer/ sharer		✓	24" Whoever wants to be my disciple must deny themselves and take up their cross and follow me."
Mangio, Ralph Lui	1st reading/sharer		✓	24" Whoever wants to be my disciple must deny themselves and take up their cross and follow me."
Masbang, Miguel Derick	2nd reading/sharer		✓	24" Whoever wants to be my disciple must deny themselves and take up their cross and follow me."
Mendoza, Gerail C.	3rd reading/sharer		✓	23 “Get behind me, Satan! You are a stumbling block to me; you do not have in mind the concerns of God, but merely human concerns.”
Ochoa, Bianca Claire	Closing prayer/sharer		✓	24" Whoever wants to be my disciple must deny themselves and take up their cross and follow me."

Group Reflection:

When we carry our cross, we are not alone. Jesus is with us every step of the way. He understands our pain and suffering, and He promises to give us strength to endure. He also promises that our suffering will not be in vain. By carrying our cross, we are participating in the redemptive work of Christ, and we are helping to bring about His kingdom on earth. We believe that following Jesus means striving for purity of heart, compassion, and selflessness. We believe that it requires a commitment to live out His love, grace, and forgiveness in a world often characterized by selfishness and division. We also believe that being a disciple of Jesus is not a casual or convenient commitment, but a deep and unwavering commitment to living out the teachings and principles of Christianity. We chose this saying because it represents our current life, where we continue to trust and follow Jesus despite the repercussions and changes that come our way. We believe that Jesus knows what is best for us and that following Him is the path to a life filled with enduring purpose, peace, and fulfillment. We feel sorry for the times when we have put our own interests ahead of God's and asks for forgiveness and guidance. We believe that following Jesus is a journey worth taking and that He will preserve our life if we give it to Him.

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We are humbled by the truth that Jesus has shared, and we ask for His help to let go of our selfishness and to seek His purpose for our lives. We embrace the symbolism of taking up our cross, knowing that life's trials and tribulations are part of our journey. We ask for strength and faith to face these challenges with grace, knowing that we can draw them closer to Jesus. The author also prays for guidance and wisdom to live out Jesus' teachings in our daily life. We want to be an instrument of His love, grace, and forgiveness in a world that often needs it most. We also understand that being a disciple of Jesus requires a deep commitment and sacrifice. We are willing to deny ourselves, to let go of our desires and ego, and to take up our cross, embracing the challenges and difficulties that may come on our way in following Jesus' path. We ask for God's strength, wisdom, and faith to follow Him wholeheartedly. We conclude by saying that we give our life to the Lord and that we have faith in what He says. We are committed to following Jesus and to living a life of selflessness, love, and service to others. The verse Matthew 16:23 is a reminder that following Jesus requires us to deny ourselves and to put His interests before our own. It is also a reminder that Satan will tempt us to use our power for selfish gain, but we must resist him and follow Jesus' example of humility and selflessness.

The Lord is calling us to a transformation of our mind, heart, and life. This means renewing our thinking to align with His teachings, cultivating a heart filled with His love, and living out our faith through selfless actions. The Lord is calling for an all-encompassing change in our attitudes, sentiments, and deeds. It's an invitation to connect every aspect of our being with His guidance and example. This ongoing process of conversion necessitates constant development, humility, and reliance on God's grace. It's a path towards living a life that is more like Christ in every way. The Lord is asking us to give our lives to Him, to have faith in Him, and to live life by His name. He is calling us to turn away from our selfish desires and to focus on God's will. He is asking us to have a conversion of the mind, heart, and life. Making this conversion is not easy, but it is the most important thing we can do in our lives. When we make this conversion, we will find true happiness and fulfillment. The verse Matthew 16:23 is a reminder of this call to conversion. Jesus rebuked Peter for trying to dissuade Him from His mission. He told Peter that he was thinking like a human, not like God. This verse reminds us that we must be willing to let go of our own desires and follow God's will, even when it is difficult.

Photo Documentation:

